

INFORMATION ABOUT THE STUDY

-Exploring Camera Based Inputs to Strengthen Natural Interaction in Social Robots-

Introduction

We are asking you to participate in a scientific study at Radboud University.

Participation is voluntary.

Before you decide whether to take part, this letter explains what the study is about.

Please read this information carefully and ask the researcher for clarification if you have any questions. Contact details are at the end of the letter.

Description and Purpose of the Study

The goal of this study is to explore whether facial recognition and hand gestures can be used to improve the interaction between humans and digital avatars in a home-like environment.

During the study, you will interact with two different systems.

After these interactions, you will be asked to complete a short questionnaire about your experience and how natural or helpful the interactions felt. This will be followed by a brief interview to clarify your answers.

Who is conducting the research?

This study is part of a Master's thesis in the Artificial Intelligence program at Radboud University.

The research is conducted by Rodrigo Rivera under the supervision of Martijn Vastenburg.

What does participation involve?

In this study, you will interact with two different digital systems. Each interaction will last about 10 minutes and will take place in a home-like environment.

During one of the interactions, a picture of you will be taken to support the system's ability to interact with you. After both interactions, you will be asked to complete a short questionnaire about your experience, focusing on how natural and helpful the interactions felt.

Finally, a brief interview will be conducted to discuss your answers in more detail. The entire session will take approximately 30 minutes.

Risks and Discomfort

The potential risks of this study are considered minimal.

It complies with the ethical guidelines of the “Light Track” defined by the Ethics Committee for the Social Sciences (ECSS) at Radboud University.

The researcher confirmed this by completing the checklist for the Light Track.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation in this study is voluntary.

You may withdraw from the study at any time without giving a reason.

Withdrawing from the study will have no negative consequences for you.

What data do we collect and how is it handled?

We will collect research data for scientific purposes.

The data will be collected anonymously.

During the interview, we will make audio recordings. These recordings will be transcribed, and any identifiable information such as names will be removed.

After transcription, the audio recordings will be deleted.

A photo of me may be taken during the study to support the system’s functioning.

Your data may be useful for future research.

The anonymous research data will be kept for at least 10 years and made available to other researchers.

Because the data is anonymous, it cannot be traced back to you.

All data will be stored securely following Radboud University guidelines.

Access for Quality Control

Certain individuals may need to access your data to ensure it has been stored properly.

These individuals include the data officer and designated data management staff at Radboud University.

They are bound to confidentiality.

Your Consent

Your data may only be used for this research if you give your consent by signing the consent form.

You may withdraw your consent even after participating.

You have up to two weeks after participation to request deletion of your data by emailing rodrigo.rivera@ru.nl.

If you withdraw consent, all collected data up to that point will be deleted.

Questions?

If you have questions or would like more information, you can contact:

rodrigo.rivera@ru.nl

CONSENT FORM

for participation in the scientific study: -Exploring Camera Based Inputs to Strengthen Natural Interaction in Social Robots-

Participant Declaration

- I have received an explanation about the purpose of the study.
- I have had the opportunity to ask questions about the study.
- All the questions I asked have been answered to my satisfaction.
- I have had sufficient time to consider my participation in the study.
- I am participating in the study voluntarily.
- I understand that I may stop participating at any time during the study if I wish.
- I understand how the research data will be stored and used.
- I agree that the data officer and designated data management staff at Radboud University may access my data.
- I understand that I have the right to withdraw my consent for the use of my research data, as described in the information sheet.
- I consent to participate in the study as described in the information sheet.

I also agree that:

- Audio recordings of me may be made for scientific purposes.
- A photo of me may be taken during the study to support the system's functioning.
- The anonymized research data will be available for at least 10 years for verification and reuse in future scientific research.

I agree to participate in the study.

Name:

.....

Signature:

Date:

Declaration by the Researcher

I declare that I have provided the person named above with accurate information about the study.

Name:
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Signature:

Date:
